
Plan Overview

A Data Management Plan created using DMPonline

Title: Investigating Financial Content on YouTube: Identifying Trends, NLP Analysis and Automated Detection of Misleading Financial Claims

Creator: Nathan Sali

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Data Manager: Nathan Sali

Project Administrator: Tugrulcan Elmas

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Affiliation: University of Edinburgh

Template: UoE Default DMP template for PGRs

Project abstract:

Financial content on YouTube has proliferated into a largely unregulated ecosystem of money-making advice, yet no systematic computational study has mapped it or distinguished legitimate guidance from misleading claims at scale. This project addresses both gaps using the YouNiverse dataset, extended to 2026 via the YouTube Data API. Phase one applies FASTopic to construct a cross-strategy taxonomy of hustlesphere content and trace strategy lifecycle trajectories. Phase two develops an NLP classifier combining gradient-boosted and transformer-based models, trained on a purpose-built labelled dataset of 800-1,000 videos annotated against externally validated criteria. Outputs include the first unified hustlesphere taxonomy, a reusable labelled dataset, and a proof-of-concept classifier targeting a Macro F1 of 0.65 to 0.72, with direct applications to platform governance and regulatory monitoring.

ID: 206000

Start date: 01-06-2026

End date: 21-08-2026

Last modified: 08-06-2026

Investigating Financial Content on YouTube: Identifying Trends, NLP Analysis and Automated Detection of Misleading Financial Claims

Administrative Information

1) School or Institute

- CSE - School of Informatics

2) Name and Contact details of supervisor(s)

Tugrulcan Elmas (T.J.Elmas)

tugrulcan@ed.ac.uk

3) Project start date

2026-06-01

4) Project end date

2026-08-21

Data Collection

5) Data Collection

Data will be collect via the YouNiverse Dataset comprising of data on YouTube up to 2019 and then extended via the YouTube API with further anonymisation (in addition to the YouTube API anonymisation).

Documentation & Metadata

6) Documentation & Metadata

Data will have clear description of each metadata and be treated with respect to the identification potential of metadata which may be traced back to a particular user, so metadata is treated with anonymisation in the study. It is important to note that through the actual dissertation and the write-up there is no current plan to mention any particular channel names, user names nor video descriptions or titles, only the aggregation of these data and metadata will be discussed, and as this is at scale it means that only the trends are being discussed, adding another layer of anonymity.

Ethics & Legal Compliance

7) Ethics & Legal Compliance

This project analyses publicly available YouTube metadata (titles, descriptions, tags, view counts) and auto-generated transcripts from the YouNiverse dataset which is anonymized. It does not involve direct interaction with human participants, nor collection of personally identifiable information, nor intervention in platform ecosystems.

Storage and Back-Up

8) Where will your data be stored and backed-up during the project?

Data will be stored and backed up securely on high capacity hard drives with password protected access.

Selection and Preservation

9) Where will the data be stored long-term?

The data will be deleted after use - nevertheless can be accessed once again via the YouTube API and the publicly available YouNiverse dataset.

10) Which data will be retained long-term?

The results from the data will be retained long-term in the report of the dissertation itself but the data will be stored until the course is completed and the dissertation is over. Upon completion, the data will be deleted.

Data Sharing

11) Will the data produced from your project be made open?

- No: go to 13

13) Please explain why your data cannot be made open.

The data is already open to the public, it is not something we plan to make public as it is widely available already to the general public.

Responsibilities & Resources

14) Who will be responsible for the research data management of this project?

The students undertaking the dissertation project.

15) Will you require any training or resources to properly manage your research data throughout this project?

Training has already been completed via the Edinburgh University via the Learn Ultra courses on Data Management.